

REPORT WARNS OF MEASLES ROARING BACK

A disease ‘eliminated’ in U.S. in 2000 could be ever-present again if current vaccination rates hold, study says.

By CORINNE PURTILL

In December, Stanford School of Medicine colleagues Dr. Nathan Lo and Mathew Kiang got to talking.

Childhood immunization rates were slowly but steadily falling nationwide, from 95% in the years before the pandemic to less than 93% in the 2023-24 school year.

If even that relatively small decline in vaccinations for measles, mumps and rubella, or MMR; diphtheria, tetanus and pertussis, or DTaP; polio; and varicella held, they wondered, what would U.S. infectious-disease prevalence look like in 10 years, or 20? What would happen if vaccination rates went up by a little bit, or fell by a whole lot?

Lo and Kiang put together a statistical model representative of the U.S. population and ran the results.

They found that if current vaccination rates hold steady over coming decades, measles — currently spreading in many parts of the country, but primarily in the Southwest — will once again be endemic in the U.S. within 25 years.

Their results were published Thursday in the Journal of the American Medical Assn.

Measles was technically “eliminated” in the U.S. in 2000, meaning the disease became rare enough — and immunity widespread enough — that even if a case or two were to arise within a community, local transmission would quickly grind to a halt. In the 25 years since, there have been 10,570 measles cases, including the 800 people sickened in the outbreak that began in west Texas in January.

But at current vaccination rates, Lo and Kiang estimate there could be as many as 851,300 measles cases between now and 2050. By their [See **Measles**, A7]



DAMIAN DOVARGANES Associated Press

THE ICONIC Hollywood sign, an emblem of California’s entertainment industry, is seen in January.



RICARDO DEARATANHA Los Angeles Times

CLUSTERS of Merlot grapes hang on the vines at Napa Valley’s Cakebread Cellars in Rutherford, Calif.



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

AN ELECTRIC self-driving vehicle from Mountain View-based Waymo travels in Santa Monica in 2023.



MYUNG J. CHUN Los Angeles Times

AMID tariffs that could jeopardize the state economy, shipping containers pile up at the Port of Los Angeles.

ICE check-ins for Southeast Asians leading to deportation

Normally routine visits turn worrying for Cambodian, Laotian and Vietnamese immigrants whose orders had long been stayed

By MELISSA GOMEZ

A growing number of Southeast Asian immigrants in Los Angeles and Orange counties whose deportation orders have been on indefinite hold for years are being detained, and in some cases, deported after showing up for routine check-ins at U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement offices, according to immigrant attorneys and advocacy groups.

In recent months, a number of Cambodian, Laotian and Vietnamese immigrants whose orders had been stayed — in some cases for decades — have been told that they will be enforced as the Trump administration seeks to increase the number of deportations.

The immigrants being targeted are generally people who were convicted of a [See **Migrants**, A8]



DAMIAN DOVARGANES Associated Press

AN IMMIGRANT deemed a threat to public safety and national security waits to be processed by Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents in L.A. in 2022.

Pope’s daily calls for peace resonate in Gaza

By BILAL SHBEIR AND NABIH BULOS

GAZA CITY — “Pope o’clock.” That’s what Gaza residents sheltering in this besieged Catholic parish called the time — usually 8 p.m. local time, 7 p.m. in Rome — when Pope Francis would video call Father Gabriel Romanelli, the pastor of the Holy Family Church in Gaza City.

“When he called, everyone would gather near the screen and say hello, in Italian, in Arabic, in English,” said Romanelli, one of Gaza’s last remaining priests.

In a place where killing seems omnipresent, the all-too-ordinary death of Pope Francis, who died Monday at 88, may have passed with little more than a moment’s thought for some. But for the church officials and the families at Holy Family [See **Francis**, A4]



OMAR AL-QATTA AFP/Getty Images

FATHER Gabriel Romanelli, pastor of the Holy Family Church in Gaza City, said Francis “truly became a member of the congregation” with his regular video calls.

Reservoir needs further repair

New leaks are found in the Pacific Palisades site’s floating cover, delaying reopening. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Traffic declines at Port of L.A.

Arrivals will drop by 35% in next two weeks because of Trump’s tariffs, executive director says. **BUSINESS, A9**

Clippers result, coverage online

For full coverage of Game 3 against the Nuggets, go to the eNewspaper and latimes.com/sports.

Weather

Low clouds clearing. L.A. Basin: 65/51. **B6**

For the latest news, go to latimes.com.



State eclipses Japan in economic rankings

Governor touts California’s climb to No. 4 globally amid concerns over tariff consequences.

By HANNAH FRY AND CLARA HARTER

If California were its own country, its economy would now rank as the fourth-largest of any nation across the globe, Gov. Gavin Newsom said, a new milestone that comes at a time of major economic turbulence.

California has long been a global powerhouse, fueled by a variety of sectors including technology, agriculture, tourism and entertainment. The new ranking comes as the state is facing challenges from a trade war with China and other nations that are key California trading partners.

Newsom announced the state’s new economic ranking Wednesday after recently released data from the International Monetary Fund and the U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis indicated that California’s nominal gross domestic product now exceeds Japan’s.

According to the data, California’s nominal GDP reached \$4.1 trillion, surpassing Japan’s \$4.02 trillion. That places the Golden State behind only the United States at \$29.18 trillion, China at \$18.74 trillion and Germany at \$4.65 trillion.

“California isn’t just keeping pace with the world — we’re setting the pace,” Newsom said in a statement. “Our economy is thriving because we invest in people, prioritize sustainability, and believe in the power of innovation.”

[See **California**, A10]

California nonprofits are ready for a fight

One group of health clinics is organizing a campaign against Trump’s program cuts.

By JAMES RAINEY

With the Trump administration slashing budgets and threatening to revoke tax-exempt status for nonprofits, some Southern California social justice organizations have gone into a defensive crouch, hoping to wait out the passing storm.

They are not openly fighting President Trump’s program cuts. Some have scrubbed their websites of terms such as “equity,” “inclusion” and “transgender.” Others have been told they should drop land acknowledgments — proclamations paying tribute to the Indigenous peoples who were this region’s first human inhabitants.

But other local nonprofits intend to fight. They have slammed Trump’s policies. They declined suggestions to alter their mission statements. They have gone to [See **Nonprofits**, A7]



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